

Bid Adjustment Quick Reference

Rules of thumb for keyword bids and placement modifiers, at a glance.

Rules of thumb for adjusting keyword and placement bids. Always change one lever at a time and give it at least a few days of data before judging the result.

Keyword Bid Adjustments

Situation	Typical move
ACOS well under target, low impression share	Raise bid 10–20% to capture more volume
ACOS well under target, already winning most impressions	Leave bid — you're already efficient at this volume
ACOS above target, has orders	Lower bid 10–15%, re-check in a few days
ACOS above target, zero orders, meaningful spend	Consider pausing the keyword or converting to negative if it's a search term, not a product
New keyword, little data yet	Start conservative, near the account's break-even CPC; don't judge before ~100 conversions

Placement Bid Modifiers

- **Top of Search (first page)** — usually the highest-converting placement but the most expensive. Worth a positive modifier on proven, high-converting keywords.
- **Rest of Search** — cheaper, lower visibility. Good default for broad discovery keywords.
- **Product Pages** — competitor conquering territory; performance varies a lot by category — test before committing a large modifier.

A Simple Decision Flow

If ACOS is...	...and orders are...	Then
Below target	Present	Raise bid — you have room
Below target	Zero (low spend)	Leave it — not enough data yet
Above target	Present	Lower bid, keep watching
Above target	Zero (high spend)	Pause or negate — this is a bleeder

These are starting heuristics, not a substitute for judgment. Seasonality, new competitors, and Amazon's own algorithm changes can all move performance independent of your bids.